



Advanced Practice Portfolio

Varshini Chandrashekar

2410917

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Artist statement

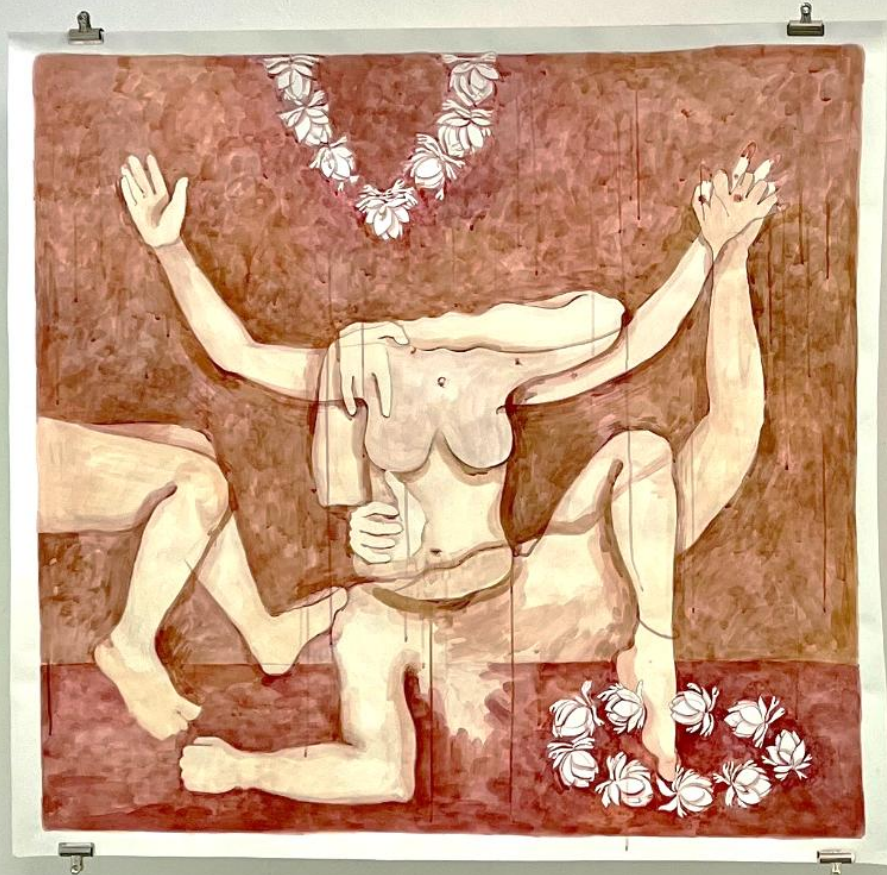
'Wanting to be Wanted' is a series of figurative paintings that explores female desire and the desire to be desired. Through fragmented bodies and intimate gestures: how a hand rests, a body leans, or touch is implied, the work examines how human desire cannot be fully masked and reveals itself through bodily presence and interaction. Painted from observation and personal memory, these compositions often begin with a single body and gradually build through the relationships between other bodies around it.

As an Indian artist, the work emerges from the lived experience of Varshini Chandrashekar and reflects on growing up within a culture where female desire and nudity are heavily policed. Reclaiming desire from a female perspective becomes both a personal and political act. The work questions how women are viewed, consumed, and reduced to body parts under the male gaze.

Using a range of mediums, primarily watercolour and diluted emulsion on paper, the paintings use partial bodies to suggest both vulnerability and resistance. They reflect the emotional and psychological effects of objectification, voyeurism, and sexualisation. Rather than presenting idealised bodies, the works hold ambiguity and the quiet tension between wanting and being wanted.



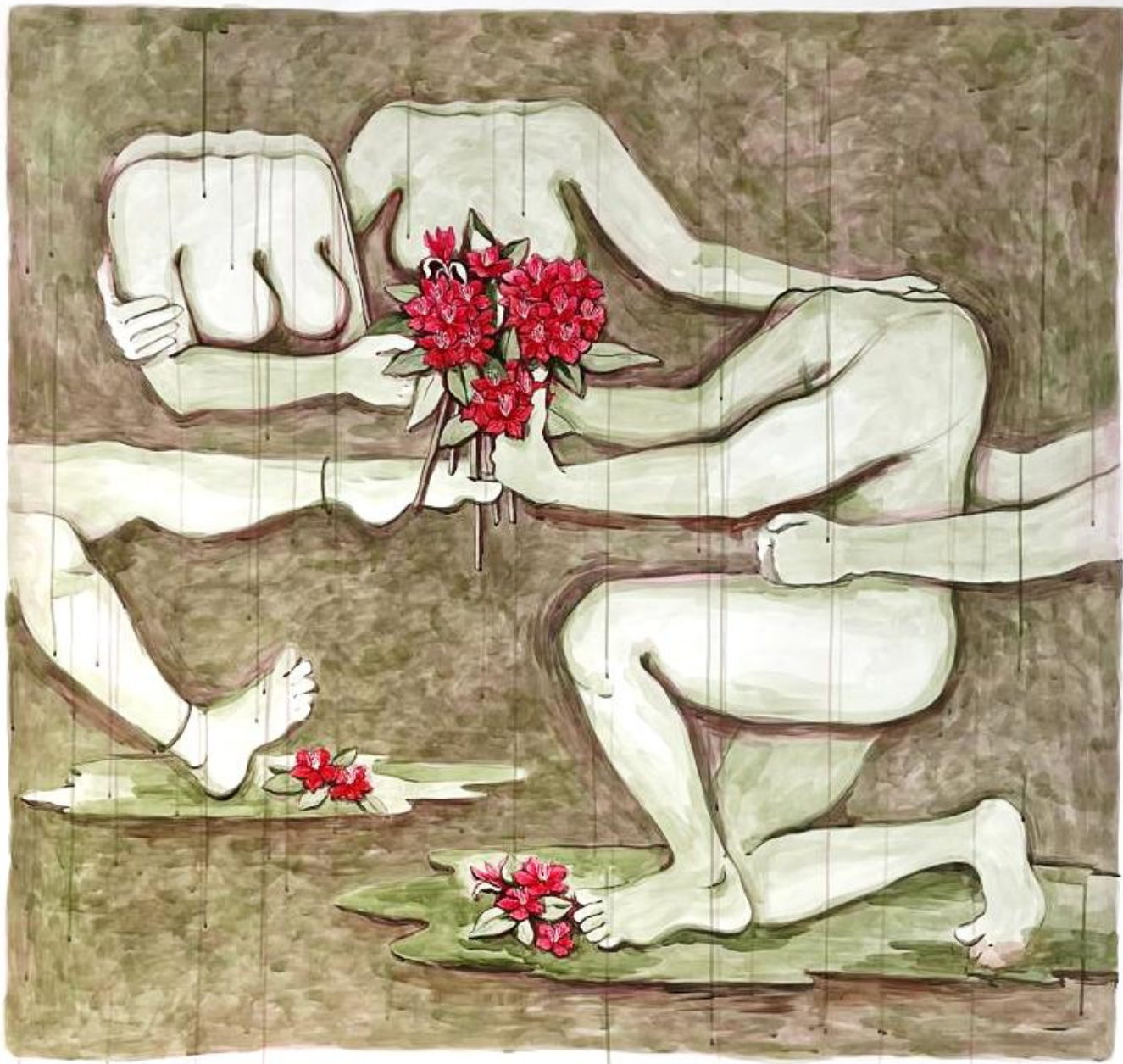
To sit with you, 2026
Emulsion and watercolour on paper
150 x 150 cms



To be with you, 2026
Emulsion and watercolour on paper
150 x 150 cms



To be with you, 2026
Emulsion and watercolour on paper
150 x 150 cms



To want you, 2026
Emulsion and watercolour on paper
150 x 150 cms

Untitled, 2026

Water colour and Emulsion on paper, A2





Here and there, 2026

Emulsion on MDF, 101 x 101 cms

Looking for a sign?

This work explores the psychological power of signboards and the way human attention has been conditioned to respond to them instantly. In everyday life, signs instruct, warn, direct, and regulate behaviour so frequently that reading them becomes almost automatic. Yet while we easily give our attention to these public commands, it often becomes difficult to remain present with nature, emotion, desire, or our own inner thoughts. We are constantly trained to interpret and decode, often at the expense of simply experiencing.

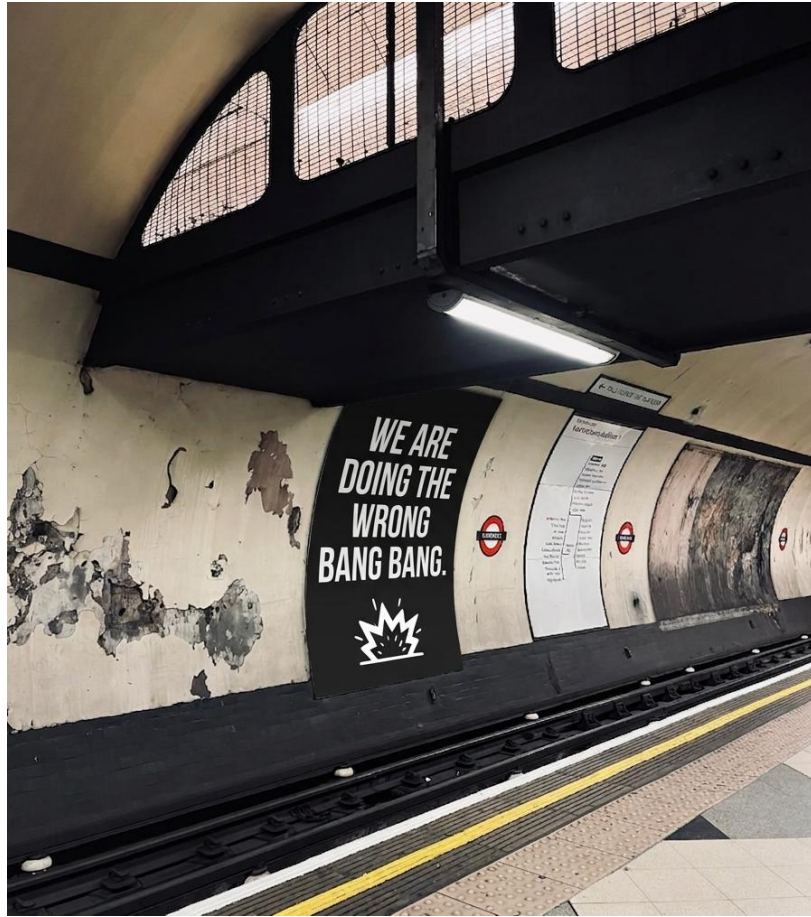
Using the familiar visual language of signage, this project attempts to redirect attention inward. The signs interrupt habitual ways of looking and encourage moments of reflection, curiosity, and self-awareness. By borrowing the aesthetics of instruction and caution, the work examines how systems of communication shape emotional and psychological states, keeping individuals in continuous alertness and subtle anxiety.

Inspired by text-based artists such as Jenny Holzer and Barbara Kruger, the work uses short phrases and visual immediacy to question how meaning is constructed and absorbed in public space. Rather than offering direct answers, the installation invites viewers to pause, observe, and reconsider the ways attention is controlled and consumed.

Looking for a sign?' 2026
AI generated digital imagery











The website has also been an important part of my making process during this term. I wanted it to function as a piece in itself that presents the entire body of work and reflects my practice visually and conceptually. Although I have not uploaded all the works yet, designing the website has been an exciting and rewarding process. It has helped me think about how my work is experienced digitally and professionally beyond gallery spaces. The website currently works as a platform for my portfolio and CV, and I hope to continue expanding it further. Please check it out. Thank you!

www.varshinichandrashekar.com